E-tiGo — Phase 2 Decisions: Quick Reference

Prepared by: Engineering Team
Date: 16 October 2026
Updated: 18 October 2026 (version 2.0: every Phase 2 decision with its reasons, alternatives and trade-offs; scheduled rides added; Lost & Found, the build choices and the Phase 2 review added)
Status: All Phase 2 features are **built** (scheduled rides 16 October; third-party bookings, Lost & Found, disputes, multi-city, driver scheduling and vehicle maintenance 18 October) and were reviewed on 18 October 2026. The client decided the scheduled-ride booking window and fees. **Every other decision here is an engineering default awaiting client confirmation.** Each one is a setting operations can change without a release, so confirming a different option is a configuration change, not new work. Two things wait for the client before they take effect: **no new city goes live without its launch date (OQ-22)**, and **no Lost & Found return fee is charged until the client sets one (OQ-36)**.

Executive Summary

Phase 2 added seven features: scheduled rides, rides booked for someone else, Lost & Found, dispute tiers, new cities, driver scheduling and vehicle maintenance. Building them needed answers to the open questions below and to many smaller questions along the way. This report gives, for each decision, **what we built, why, the other options the client can pick, and what our choice gives up**.

The recommendations follow two principles:

- **Industry practice.** We follow what Uber, Bolt, Lyft and DoorDash do where their approach is public, adjusted for Nigeria.
- **Flexibility.** Each answer is a setting with a safe default, not a hard-coded rule.

Labels (as in the Open Questions Decision Report): CLIENT decided by the client · PRODUCT OWNER approved by E-tiGo's product owner, not yet confirmed by the client · ENGINEERING engineering default, awaiting client confirmation.

#	Question	Decision	Decided by	Main trade-off	Client action
SR-1	Scheduled booking window	30 min – 3 days ahead, 3 upcoming bookings (30 min apart)	Client (gap: engineering)	No bookings more than 3 days ahead	Confirm the 30-min gap
SR-2	When matching starts	15 min before pickup; search until 10 min after	Engineering	Earlier ties drivers up; later risks late pickups	Confirm
SR-3	Reservation fee	None	Client	Drivers are not paid for committing unless the passenger cancels late	—
SR-4	Late-cancellation fee	Economy base fare, within 30 min; can be disputed	Client (reading and disputes: engineering)	A low fee may not cover the driver's blocked slot	Confirm "base fare" reading
SR-5	Fee that cannot be charged	Balance due	Client	Some balances may never be paid	—
SR-6	Drivers who often release	No penalty; tracked	Engineering	Unreliable drivers can keep reserving	**Decide**
SR-7	Driver reservation limits	5, 60 min apart, no offers 60 min before	Engineering	Driver loses on-demand trips before a reserved pickup	Confirm

#	Question	Decision	Decided by	Main trade-off	Client action
OQ-34	Collecting a balance due	No booking until paid	Engineering	A small debt stops a passenger riding	Confirm
OQ-35	When the driver is paid	When the passenger pays	Engineering	Drivers wait, and may never get some money	Confirm
OQ-18	Who gets the PIN and tracking	Both rider and booker	Engineering	One message per ride; the booker sees the PIN	Confirm, or B / C
OQ-19	Maintenance scope	General for all + EV items by fuel type	Engineering	More papers to keep up to date	Confirm intervals
OQ-20	Shifts or availability	Voluntary plans; shifts for shared fleet cars	Engineering	Two systems; operations keep a timetable	Confirm; list shared cars
OQ-21	Dispute tiers	3 tiers + Safety; ₦5k / ₦50k	Engineering	A new role to staff; extra step on large refunds	Confirm; name Support Leads
OQ-22	Cities and dates	Checklist-gated, driver-first launches	Engineering; **dates: client**	A launch waits until the gates pass	**Give the dates**
OQ-36	Lost & Found return fee	₦2,000 to the driver; built off	Engineering	Passengers pay for a return	**Decide**
OQ-37	Sharing phone numbers	Yes, once the driver has the item	Engineering	Numbers exposed until masked calling exists	Confirm, or messages only
RV-01–07	Phase 2 review fixes	See the last section	Engineering	See the last section	Confirm

Scheduled Rides (SR-1 to SR-7, OQ-34, OQ-35)

Built 16 October 2026. Full benchmarks and settings: Scheduled Rides Decisions Report.

Passengers book up to 3 days ahead at a price fixed at booking. Drivers can reserve a booking in advance; 15 minutes before pickup the ride goes to that driver or is matched like any other ride.

#	Decision	Why	Alternatives	What our choice gives up
SR-1 CLIENT	30 minutes to 3 days ahead; 3 upcoming bookings per passenger	Matches Bolt's London and South Africa launches; a short horizon keeps the locked price close to current rates	Lyft: 7 days. Uber: 30–90 days	Trips more than 3 days away (an airport run next week) cannot be booked yet
SR-1 gap ENGINEERING	One passenger's bookings at least 30 minutes apart (bookings for different riders never clash)	Catches accidental double bookings	No gap; 60 minutes	Two short trips less than 30 minutes apart cannot both be booked ahead
SR-2 ENGINEERING	Matching starts 15 minutes before pickup and searches until 10 minutes after; reminder 60 minutes before	Covers a typical pickup drive in Lagos traffic, with a margin; a passenger who planned around the ride would rather wait a little than lose it	Start 20–30 minutes before; stop at the pickup time	Starting earlier keeps drivers waiting; starting later risks late pickups in traffic
SR-3 CLIENT	No reservation fee	Booking ahead costs the passenger nothing extra	Uber Reserve charges one (£3–£5 in the UK)	Drivers are not paid for committing to a booking unless it is cancelled late

#	Decision	Why	Alternatives	What our choice gives up
SR-4 CLIENT	Late-cancellation fee = the economy base fare, within 30 minutes of the ride, only for bookings a driver reserved; paid to that driver in full	Pays the driver for the slot they blocked; safety, emergency, wrong-car and no-show cancellations never pay	Uber: the trip's minimum fare, 1 hour before. Lyft: a flat fee, 30 minutes before	A base fare may not fully cover a driver who turned down other trips
SR-4 reading ENGINEERING	"Base economy fee" read as the economy **base fare**, not the minimum fare	The base fare is the fare's fixed part, and is lower	The economy minimum fare	If the client meant the minimum fare, the fee is lower than intended
SR-5 CLIENT	A fee that cannot be charged (cash, short wallet, declined card), and a wallet fare the wallet cannot cover, becomes a **balance due**	Cash bookings cannot be charged after the fact	Waive it; add it to the next ride's fare	Some balances may never be paid
SR-6 ENGINEERING	No penalty for drivers who often release reservations; every release is in the audit log	The Cancellation Fee Proposal recommends tracking driver cancellations, not fining them	Bolt stops repeat offenders from reserving	Unreliable drivers can keep reserving until operations step in
SR-7 ENGINEERING	Up to 5 reservations per driver, 60 minutes apart; no on-demand offers in the 60 minutes before a reserved pickup	Stops hoarding and protects the pickup, as Uber does	Fewer or more; a shorter protection window	The driver gives up on-demand trips in the hour before the pickup
OQ-34 ENGINEERING	A passenger who owes a balance cannot book until they pay it, all at once, by wallet or card; Finance can waive it or switch the block off	Uber and Bolt do the same	Add it to the next fare (needs the driver to collect cash on cash rides)	A passenger with a small debt cannot ride until they pay
OQ-35 ENGINEERING	The driver is paid when the passenger pays	E-tiGo does not carry passengers' debts	Pay the driver at once and collect later (Uber)	Drivers wait for the money, and may never receive some of it

OQ-18 — Third-Party Bookings: Who Gets the PIN and Tracking?

Decided by: ENGINEERING

A passenger (the **booker**) books and pays for a ride for someone else (the **rider**), such as a parent, child, guest or colleague. Bolt reports that **2–6% of its rides** are already booked for someone else, usually informally.

Industry practice. On Uber, the rider gets a text with the driver's details and a link to follow the driver, and the booker can follow the trip in their own app. The rider does not need the app.

Decision (built 18 October 2026)

> **PIN: both. Tracking: both.**
>
> - The **rider** gets a WhatsApp message (SMS if WhatsApp fails) when a driver is assigned. It contains the booker's first name, the driver's name, car and plate, the **ride PIN**, and a **live tracking link** that works without the app (the page shows the driver's photo).
> - The **booker** sees the same PIN and live map in their app, so they can pass the PIN on if the rider's message doesn't arrive.
> - Operations can change either setting to rider only or booker only.

Why both: the person getting into the car must say the PIN, so the rider needs it. Phones in Nigeria are often off, out of data or on a different number, so the booker needs a copy as a fallback. The booker paid for the trip and is responsible for the rider, so seeing the PIN carries no real risk.

Options and trade-offs

Option	PIN goes to	Tracking goes to	When to choose it	What it gives up
A (built)	Rider + booker	Rider + booker	Fewest failed pickups; best for families and guests	One WhatsApp/SMS per ride; the booker also sees the PIN
B	Rider only	Rider + booker	If the client wants the strictest PIN control	Little real gain: when the rider's message fails, the booker is shown the PIN anyway so the ride can start
C	Booker only	Booker only	Cheapest (no messages to the rider)	The booker must phone the rider with the car and PIN; a rider without the car details is easier to send to the wrong car

Edge cases and how we handle them

Situation	What happens
The rider's message fails to deliver (WhatsApp and SMS both fail)	The booker is alerted in the app and shown the PIN **whatever the setting**, so the ride can still start
The rider's number is the booker's own number	Treated as a normal ride, not a third-party one
The rider already has an E-tiGo account	Still messaged by WhatsApp/SMS. We never tell the booker whether a number has an account (privacy). The trip stays in the booker's history
Who pays	The **booker** pays, by **wallet or card only** by default. Cash and bank transfer are off, because the payer is not in the car. Operations can turn cash on
The booker wants their own ride at the same time	Allowed. A third-party ride does not count as the booker's active ride. Limit: **2 active third-party rides** per booker
Scheduled third-party ride	Allowed. The rider gets a reminder 60 minutes before pickup. The PIN is sent at dispatch, as for every scheduled ride
The driver needs to call the rider	The driver sees the rider's first name and can call the rider's number while the trip is active
Safety	The tracking page shows the driver, car and plate, a "Call 112" button and the E-tiGo safety line. The booker's in-app SOS works for the rider's trip and gives the Safety team the rider's number

Situation	What happens
The booker changes the PIN	The new PIN is sent to the rider again
Cancelling	Only the booker can cancel. The rider's message says to contact the booker for changes
Rating, disputes, lost items	Handled by the booker, who has the account
Someone uses the feature to spam a number	Limit of **10 different rider numbers per booker per 24 hours**. The message names the booker, so the rider knows it is not a scam
Children	Riders must be 18 or over unless an adult travels with them (Uber's rule). The booker confirms this when booking
The setting changes while rides are in progress	The setting is saved on each ride at booking, so changes apply only to new bookings
Tracking link after the trip	Expires 1 hour after the trip ends (the existing share-link rule)

Choices made while building ENGINEERING

Choice	What we built	Why	Alternative	What it gives up
Who the ride belongs to	The booker stays the ride's passenger; the rider is a name and number on the ride	Payment, cancellation, rating, receipts and history work unchanged	Make the rider a passenger account of their own	The driver's rating of the trip goes to the booker; the rider has no trip history
Daily number limit	A rolling 24 hours, counting cancelled bookings	Booking and cancelling cannot be used to message many numbers	A calendar day; count completed rides only	A booker who cancels a lot reaches the limit sooner
Messages to the rider	Driver details, plus "driver arrived" and "cancelled" updates (on by default)	The rider is not in the app and needs to know the car is outside	Driver details only	More messages per ride; operations can turn the updates off
Links in booker-typed text	Removed from the rider's message (names, addresses)	Stops the feature being used to send phishing links from E-tiGo's number	Send the text as typed	A real link typed into an address is lost
Booker SOS location	The car's live position	The booker is not in the car, so their phone's location is wrong	The booker's phone location	Depends on the driver app sending its location
Tracking page	A simple page served by the backend (`/track/{ride}/{token}`)	The rider may not have the app, and the page was needed now	Wait for the web team	Basic design; the web team can replace it with one setting
"Delivered" status	Not used yet; we record which channel accepted the message	The SMS provider's delivery reports are not connected yet	Connect delivery reports	We know a channel accepted the message, not that the phone received it; the booker fallback covers failures
Scheduled bookings for others	Limited by the scheduled-ride limits (3 upcoming), not the 2-active limit; dispatch is never refused because of it	Refusing a booking at pickup time would strand the rider	Check the 2-active limit against the pickup time when booking	A booker can briefly have more than 2 rides for others on the road

OQ-19 — Vehicle Charging & Maintenance: EV-Only, General, or Both?

Decided by: **ENGINEERING**

Decision (built 18 October 2026)

> **Both, chosen automatically from the vehicle's fuel type.**
>
> - **Every vehicle:** routine service, tyres and brakes check, and the legal papers: insurance, roadworthiness certificate and vehicle licence.
> - **Plug-in vehicles only** (electric and plug-in hybrid): battery health check and charging status.
> - Records belong to the **vehicle**, not the driver, so they stay with the car if it changes hands (common for fleet cars).

Why both: most drivers in Phase 2 will drive petrol or CNG cars, so an EV-only feature would leave most of the fleet without reminders. Expired insurance or roadworthiness papers are a legal and safety risk for every car. Lagos already enforces roadworthiness checks on ride-hailing drivers.

Default intervals (settings)

Item	Applies to	Default	Source of the reading
Routine service	All	Every **5,000 km or 3 months**, whichever comes first	Trip distance E-tiGo records, plus odometer readings the driver or workshop enters at each service
Tyres & brakes check	All	Every **6 months**	Date of the last check
Insurance, roadworthiness, vehicle licence	All	By **expiry date**	Uploaded paper, linked to the **vehicle**
Battery health check	Electric, plug-in hybrid	Every **12 months**	Workshop record
Charging status	Electric, plug-in hybrid	Live	Charge level the driver enters when going online, plus E-tiGo charging-station sessions. A car-telematics link can come later

Reminders and enforcement

Status	What happens
Due within 14 days	Reminder to the driver (and to operations for fleet cars)
Overdue — service, tyres, battery	Warning only. **Never blocks driving.** Shown to operations
Expired — insurance, roadworthiness, licence	**7-day grace period**, then the car cannot be driven on E-tiGo until a new paper is approved

Options and trade-offs

Option	Scope	When to choose it	What it gives up
A (built)	General + EV items, by fuel type	Covers the whole fleet	More papers and records for drivers and operations to keep up to date

Option	Scope	When to choose it	What it gives up
B	EV only (charging + battery)	If Phase 2 is fleet EVs only	Petrol and CNG cars (most of the fleet) get no reminders, and expired insurance is not caught
C	General only	If E-tiGo has no EVs at launch	No battery-health tracking; it can be switched on later

Edge cases and how we handle them

Situation	What happens
Papers expire during a trip	The trip is never interrupted. After it, the driver gets no new trips, and cannot go online again until a new paper is approved
A blocked car's driver holds scheduled-ride reservations	They are released straight away and each passenger is told, so the booking returns to the pool in time. For a shared car, every shift driver loses the pickups that fall in their shifts on that car (RV-02)
The driver changes car	The old car's records stay with it; the new car's records apply
The fuel type is corrected (for example petrol → electric)	EV items are added, or archived if the car is no longer plug-in
Non-plug-in hybrid	General items only
An odometer reading goes down	Rejected as a likely typo
Kilometres driven outside E-tiGo	Not visible to us, so the time limit (3 months) still triggers the service
Who updates records	**Fleet cars:** E-tiGo operations. **Own cars:** the driver uploads proof (receipt, certificate), operations approve
A service is booked	Uses the existing repair and maintenance request flow (`REP-` numbers), so there is one workshop process

Choices made while building ENGINEERING

Choice	What we built	Why	Alternative	What it gives up
Cars with no record yet	Shown as "No record yet" with a reminder; **only an expired paper stops a car**	Most cars have no roadworthiness or licence record on file; blocking them would take the fleet off the road on day one	Block cars with a missing paper after a deadline	A car with no paper on file can drive until one is uploaded; operations see the "no record" count
When the block starts	At once: an idle driver is set offline, gets no new trips or manual assignments, and reserved pickups are released	Stopping new trips straight away is safer	Block only the next time the driver goes online	A driver can be taken offline in the middle of a working day
Renewing a paper	The old paper stays valid until the renewal is approved; the reviewer confirms the expiry date	Uploading a renewal early should never take a car off the road	The new upload replaces the old paper at once	An expired paper keeps working until review, within the grace period; reviews must keep up
Roadworthiness and vehicle licence	New paper types; expiry date required	The expiry date drives the reminders and the block	Track insurance only	Drivers upload two more papers

Choice	What we built	Why	Alternative	What it gives up
Kilometres for the service	Last odometer reading plus each E-tiGo trip since	No car telematics yet	Time-based service only; telematics	Off-platform kilometres are missed (the 3-month limit covers them)
Reminders	One message per car when something changes; one daily operations email for fleet cars	Daily reminders teach drivers to ignore them	A reminder every day	A driver who ignores the first message hears nothing more until the status changes

OQ-20 — Driver Scheduling: Shifts or Availability Planning?

Decided by: **ENGINEERING**

Decision (built 18 October 2026)

> **Availability planning for all drivers, plus assigned shifts only for E-tiGo fleet cars that two or more drivers share.**
>
> - **Availability planning (all drivers, voluntary).** Drivers can tell E-tiGo when and where they plan to drive. There is **no penalty** for changing or skipping a plan, and drivers can **always go online** when they like. Operations use the plans to spot gaps (for example "only 8 drivers planned for Lekki, Friday 6–9 pm") and target incentives.
> - **Fleet shifts (shared fleet cars only).** Operations assign day/night shifts so two drivers can share one car with a clean handover. Operations switch shift mode on per car.

Why: Uber and Bolt do not schedule their drivers; drivers choose when to work. DoorDash lets couriers book time slots voluntarily, but they can still work without one. Forcing shifts on independent drivers would also make them look like employees, which is a legal risk for E-tiGo. A car shared by two drivers is the exception: it needs a timetable so both drivers don't claim it at once.

Options and trade-offs

Option	How it works	When to choose it	What it gives up
A (built)	Voluntary planning for all; shifts for shared fleet cars only	Keeps drivers independent; still runs shared cars properly	Two systems; operations must keep each shared car's timetable
B	Availability planning only, no shifts	If no fleet car is shared between drivers	Shared cars have no handover rules, so two drivers could claim one car
C	Assigned shifts for all drivers	Only if all drivers become E-tiGo employees	Employment-status risk; drivers lose flexibility; likely fewer drivers at unpopular hours

Shift rules (fleet cars in shift mode)

Rule	Default
Driver can go online	From **15 minutes before** to the end of their own shift
New ride offers stop	**15 minutes before the shift ends**, so the car is returned on time

Rule	Default
A trip runs past the shift end	The driver finishes the trip; the next driver is told the car may be a little late
Driver not online 30 minutes after the shift starts	Marked **missed** and operations are alerted to reassign the car. No automatic fine; the fleet agreement decides any consequence
Overlapping shifts on the same car or the same driver	Rejected
Shifts after midnight (for example 22:00–06:00)	Supported. Times are stored as full date-times in Lagos time
Scheduled-ride reservations	A fleet driver in shift mode can only reserve bookings inside their own shifts
The driver is suspended or deactivated	Their shift in progress ends and upcoming shifts are cancelled, and operations are told which slots to fill (RV-01)

Edge cases for availability plans

Situation	What happens
A driver plans hours and doesn't show up	Nothing happens to the driver. The plan is just a forecast
Plans shown to passengers	Never. Plans are for operations only and do not promise a passenger a car
A driver is suspended, or moves city	Their plans stop counting as cover; a move removes the old city's plans (RV-03, RV-04)
Shared fleet car with a driver who also has their own car	Not supported: a driver drives one car on E-tiGo at a time, so a driver with their own car is not given shifts on a shared car, and a driver on shifts is not given a car of their own (RV-05)

Choices made while building ENGINEERING

Choice	What we built	Why	Alternative	What it gives up
Handing the car over	The car passes to the next driver when they go online in their shift window, as long as the previous driver is offline and not on a trip. Until then the app tells them who still has it	No key-handover step to forget; the system always knows who has the car	Both drivers confirm the handover in the app	No record of the physical hand-over of keys
Cars on hire purchase	Cannot be put in shift mode, and a shared car cannot go on hire purchase	A car being bought by one driver is not shared	Allow a buyer to share their car on shifts	A buyer who wants a co-driver cannot use shifts
A missed shift	The driver can still go online for the rest of it; operations can reassign it	A late driver is better than an idle car	A missed shift is lost	The system does not penalise lateness; the fleet agreement decides
Rotas	Operations can create the same shift for up to 14 days in one go	Day and night rotas are the common case	Repeating weekly templates	Operations must create the rota again after 14 days
Shift ends	The driver is set offline at the end (after any trip in progress), and stays online when their next shift on the same car starts straight away	The next driver needs the car on time	Leave the driver online	A driver who wants to keep working needs another shift

Choice	What we built	Why	Alternative	What it gives up
Availability plans	Up to 14 days ahead, repeatable weekly for 3 weeks, with an optional area name	Enough for weekly planning without stale long-range plans	Longer horizons	No planning beyond 14 days

OQ-21 — Dispute Escalation Tiers and Ownership

Decided by: **ENGINEERING**

Before Phase 2 every dispute went to the Support team, and any support admin could refund up to the full fare. Phase 2 adds evidence uploads, escalation and appeals.

Decision (built 18 October 2026)

> **Three tiers, plus specialist routing for safety and payment cases.**

Tier	Owner	Handles	Refund limit per dispute
1	Support agent (existing `support` role)	Every new dispute except safety	Up to **₦5,000**
2	**Support lead** (new admin role)	Escalations, appeals, missed deadlines, repeat offenders, refunds above ₦5,000	Up to **₦50,000**
3	Super admin	Refunds above ₦50,000, permanent driver deactivation, legal, press or regulator cases, final appeals	No limit

Specialist routing	Owner
Safety concerns (assault, harassment, dangerous driving)	Go **straight to the Safety team** (`safety_operator`), skipping tier 1, with a **1-hour** first-response target. Linked to any SOS incident on the trip
Payment errors (double charges, failed refunds, chargebacks)	Support keeps the case; **Finance** must approve any money movement beyond a normal wallet refund
Lost items	Use the Phase 2 Lost & Found flow, not disputes
A scheduled-ride late-cancellation fee	The passenger can dispute it like a trip (RV-07)

Why: a three-level ladder (agent, lead, management) is the standard support model. Linking refund limits to tiers keeps small cases fast and puts a second person on large refunds. Safety cases skip the queue because every hour counts.

Response targets (settings)

Tier	First response	Resolution	If missed
Safety	1 hour	24 hours	Alert to super admin
1	24 hours	72 hours	Escalates to tier 2 automatically
2	24 hours	5 days	Alert to super admin

Options and trade-offs

Option	Structure	When to choose it	What it gives up
A (built)	3 tiers + Safety fast-track, refund limits per tier	Scales with the team; second pair of eyes on large refunds	A new role to staff (Support Lead); an extra approval step on large refunds
B	2 tiers (Support → Super admin)	A very small support team	Super admins handle every escalation and large refund; senior cases wait longer
C	Single tier with Safety fast-track	The pre-Phase 2 model with only the safety change	No second person on large refunds, so more room for error or abuse

Edge cases and how we handle them

Situation	What happens
A refund above the agent's limit	The agent proposes it; it waits for a higher-tier approver. **No one approves their own refund**
Escalating a closed dispute	Not allowed. Closed disputes reopen only through an appeal
Appeals	The passenger or driver can appeal **once, within 7 days** of the decision, to a **different** reviewer one tier above whoever decided
An appeal reverses a refund	The driver's earnings are clawed back with the existing refund clawback
Escalating above tier 3	Not possible; tier 3 is final
The assigned admin leaves or is deactivated	Their open disputes go back to their tier's shared queue
Passenger and driver both dispute the same trip	The two disputes are linked and handled by the same owner
Sending a case back down	Allowed (for example tier 2 → tier 1 with instructions); a note is required
Who sees evidence (photos, audio)	Only the assigned reviewer, higher tiers and the Safety team, as Phase 2 requires (NF-12). Every view is audit-logged
What the passenger sees	"Your case is with our senior team", never admin names

Choices made while building ENGINEERING

Choice	What we built	Why	Alternative	What it gives up
Safety team refund limit	**₦50,000**, the same as tier 2	Safety cases sit beside tier 2 and often end in a full-fare refund	A lower limit, so a second person approves	Safety operators can refund most trips without a second approval
Tier 1 misses its first-response target (24 h)	The case also moves to tier 2, not only after 72 h unresolved	An unanswered case is the worst experience	Escalate only after 72 hours unresolved	Tier 2 also gets simple cases tier 1 was slow to pick up
Appeal of a decision made by a more senior person	The appeal goes one tier above whoever decided. A super admin's decision is final	An appeal should always reach someone more senior than the first decider	Always one tier above the case's tier	Super admins receive more appeals
Where refunds go	The passenger's E-tiGo wallet by default (OQ-27). A refund to the card is possible, and always needs Finance to approve	Wallet refunds are instant; card refunds move money outside the platform	Refund to the original payment method	A card payer gets wallet credit unless the reviewer chooses the card; card refunds take longer

Choice	What we built	Why	Alternative	What it gives up
Who sees evidence at tier 1	Only the agent who has taken the case, not every agent	Keeps photos and recordings to the fewest people (NF-12)	Every tier 1 agent	An agent must take the case before seeing its evidence
Alerts	New safety cases email the Safety team; missed Safety and tier 2 targets email the super admins	The dashboard also shows overdue counts	SMS or push to an on-call person	Email can be missed at night
Settings	Only super admins change the limits and targets	Refund limits are a money control	Operations can change them too	Every change waits for a super admin

OQ-22 — Which Cities, and When?

Decided by: ENGINEERING · dates: CLIENT

The target dates are a business decision only the client can make. Engineering's role is to make sure any city can be switched on safely. Each city already has a map boundary, prices, vehicle classes, time zone and currency, so more cities need no database changes.

Decision (process built 18 October 2026)

> **Launch order: Lagos (launch city) → Abuja → Port Harcourt → Ibadan.** Each city goes live only when it passes the readiness checklist below, not on a fixed date.
>
> Suggested timing for the client to confirm: **Abuja no earlier than 6 weeks after Lagos is stable**, and Port Harcourt in the following quarter.

Why this order: after Lagos, Abuja has the most ride-hailing demand in Nigeria and many business travellers between the two cities. Port Harcourt and Ibadan are large cities where ride-hailing already operates. Launching a city only when it has enough drivers avoids long waits, which put passengers off a new city. The client's own market data should override this order.

Options and trade-offs

Option	How it works	When to choose it	What it gives up
A (built)	Driver-first soft launch: each city goes live when its checklist passes and its date arrives	Fewest bad first impressions	A launch waits until the gates pass, so a marketing date can slip
B	Launch on a fixed date, checklist advisory only	Marketing needs a firm date	Passengers may find too few cars in the first weeks
C	Open several cities at once	Fast national footprint	Operations, support and driver recruitment spread thin

City readiness checklist

#	Gate	Default
1	Map boundary drawn, with no overlap with other cities	Required
2	Prices set for every vehicle class offered; surge rules reviewed	Required
3	Approved, KYC-verified drivers in the city	**At least 30**

#	Gate	Default
4	Support and Safety cover for the city's hours	Required (confirmed by an admin)
5	State transport permits or registrations, where the state requires them	Client/Legal to confirm per state
6	Charging stations live, when the city's drivers include plug-in cars	Required in that case
7	The client's launch date	Required
8	Launch promo codes limited to the city	Optional

City states

State	Drivers	Passengers
Onboarding	Can sign up, do KYC and be approved	Cannot book; can join a waitlist
Live	Normal	Normal
Paused	No new trips except bookings made before the pause	Cannot book; trips in progress finish normally

Edge cases and how we handle them

Situation	What happens
A trip from one city ends in another or outside any city	The pickup city's prices apply, and the passenger sees a warning
A pickup inside another city's boundary booked under a live city's name	Refused, pointing the passenger to the right city (RV-06)
A driver moves city	Operations move them. Not allowed while they have an active trip, upcoming reservations or upcoming fleet shifts (RV-03)
A city is paused with scheduled bookings	**Existing bookings still go ahead by default**; operations can choose to cancel them all with a notice to each passenger
A city is paused while trips are in progress	They finish normally
Commuters living outside the city limits (for example Lagos–Ogun: Mowe, Arepo, Ibafo)	We recommend drawing the Lagos boundary to include the commuter belt
Boundaries overlap	Rejected when saved, so a pickup always maps to one city
Time zone and currency	All Nigerian cities use Lagos time and naira, so nothing changes. A city outside Nigeria would need some Lagos-time rules (payout day, promo peak hours) moved to the city's own time zone

Choices made while building ENGINEERING

Lagos, Abuja and Port Harcourt, which were already switched on, are live; Ibadan is in onboarding.

Choice	What we built	Why	Alternative	What it gives up
Resuming a paused city	No checklist the second time: a paused city can go live again at once	A pause is an emergency brake (flooding, unrest, fuel scarcity); reopening should not wait for paperwork. Operations see the checklist before resuming	Run the checklist again	A city could reopen after a permit lapsed

Choice	What we built	Why	Alternative	What it gives up
Charging stations	Required only when the city's approved drivers include electric or plug-in hybrid cars	No ride type is EV-only today	Always require stations for EV-capable classes	A city whose first EV driver joins after launch has no stations check
Drivers in a paused city	They can stay online, but only get rides passengers booked before the pause	Those bookings still need drivers	Set every driver offline	Drivers may wait online for very few rides
Drivers in an onboarding city	They can be approved but cannot go online until launch day	There are no passengers yet	Let them go online	Recruited drivers wait, idle, until launch
Passengers in a city that is not open	"E-tiGo is not available in {city} yet" with **Notify me**; everyone on the list gets one message on launch day	Turns early interest into first riders; the dashboard shows how many are waiting	Hide the city entirely	One message per waiting passenger on launch day
Pausing with bookings	Each booking that is cancelled is free, with a message saying why	The passenger did nothing wrong	Charge the late-cancellation fee	A driver who reserved the booking is not paid
Changing city	A driver chooses their city until they apply; after that only Operations can move them	Permits and documents are state-specific	Drivers move themselves	More work for operations
Boundaries	An overlap with any city is refused, including cities not yet live; cities may share a border	So a pickup always belongs to exactly one city	Check live cities only	A future city's boundary must be drawn with care before it launches

OQ-36 and OQ-37 — Lost & Found: Return Fee and Contact Details

Decided by: **ENGINEERING**

Added 18 October 2026, when Lost & Found was built.

Lost & Found follows the Uber, Bolt and Lyft model:

1. The passenger reports the item from the trip, up to **30 days** after it.
2. The driver is notified and says whether they have it.
3. If they do, the two arrange the return through messages in the app.
4. The driver marks the item returned and the passenger confirms.

Support steps in when the passenger asks, when the driver does not answer within **24 hours**, or when the return has not happened within **7 days**. Drivers can also hand in items they find.

OQ-36: Should passengers pay a return fee? Uber and Bolt charge the passenger a fee when the driver brings an item back, and the driver keeps all of it. The fee pays for the driver's time and fuel, and it is why drivers return items at all.

Option	What happens	What it gives up
A — Fee of ₦2,000 (recommended)	Charged once the item is back: from the wallet, or as a balance due if the wallet is short. All of it goes to the driver. Support can waive it	Passengers pay to get their own item back

Option	What happens	What it gives up
B — Another amount	Any amount; operations can change it at any time. A new amount applies only to items found after the change	Too low and drivers may not bother; too high and passengers complain
C — No fee (**built default until the client decides**)	Drivers return items for free	Drivers carry the fuel and time, so fewer items come back

OQ-37: Do passenger and driver see each other's phone number?

Option	What happens	What it gives up
A — Yes, once the driver has the item (recommended, built default)	Each sees the other's first name and number until the item is back. Messages in the app also work	The two numbers are exposed to each other until masked calling exists
B — Messages in the app only	No phone numbers are shared	Returns are slower, especially when the lost item is the passenger's phone

The recommendation is A because E-tiGo has no masked calling yet. Once masked calling exists, the apps can use it instead.

Edge cases planned for

Situation	What happens
The lost item is the passenger's phone	The passenger can give another number when reporting. Updates are also sent to it by SMS
The driver says "not found"	The passenger can ask support to look into it. With no follow-up within 7 days, the report closes
The driver later finds it	The driver can change the answer to "found"
The driver says it was returned but the passenger disagrees	The passenger tells support. Otherwise the report closes as resolved after 72 hours
The driver's account is suspended or deleted	The report goes straight to support
A trip booked for someone else	The booker reports it, as for ratings and disputes
Misuse	One open report per trip, and at most 3 open reports per passenger

Choices made while building ENGINEERING

Choice	What we built	Why	Alternative	What it gives up
Report window	30 days after the trip	Long enough to notice something is missing	7 or 14 days	Older reports are harder to act on
Timings	Driver silent 24 h → support; not returned in 7 days → support; "returned" closes after 72 h; "not found" closes after 7 days	Each case keeps moving without someone chasing it	Shorter or longer timers	A passenger who misses the 72-hour window has to contact support
Limits	One open report per trip; 3 open per passenger	Stops misuse	No limits	A passenger who lost several things on several trips must close one first
Return fee collection	Wallet first, else a balance due; one fee per trip	Same collection rules as other balances (OQ-34)	Charge the card	An unpaid fee blocks booking until paid

Choice	What we built	Why	Alternative	What it gives up
Who works the queue	Support and Operations; settings are Operations'	Operations know the drivers and cars	Support only	Two teams share one queue
Lost-item disputes	Disputes still accept "item left behind" for older apps	Older apps send it	Refuse it	Two routes for the same problem until all apps update

Phase 2 Review — Choices Made While Fixing Edge Cases

Added 18 October 2026. **ENGINEERING**

Engineering checked every Phase 2 task against the code: all were built. Because the features were built one after another, the review concentrated on where they meet, and found seven gaps. Each fix below needed a choice the client has not confirmed.

#	What we built	Why (the gap)	Alternatives	What it gives up
RV-01	When a driver is suspended or deactivated, their reserved scheduled pickups go back to the pool at once (passengers told), a shift in progress ends, upcoming shifts are cancelled, and operations get one email listing the slots to fill	The passenger only found out at dispatch, 15 minutes before pickup, and the car's shifts stayed blocked	Keep reservations and shifts in case the driver is reactivated soon; or only alert operations	A driver reactivated the same day must reserve again, and operations must create the shifts again
RV-02	When a shared car's papers block it, every shift driver whose shift on that car covers a reserved pickup loses it; pickups covered by a shift on another car stay	Only the driver holding the car lost reservations, and a car held by nobody released none	Move the reservation to another shared car automatically	If the renewal is approved soon after, the reservations are not restored
RV-03	Moving a driver to another city is refused while they have upcoming fleet shifts; their upcoming plans for the old city are removed	Shared cars stay in their city, so the shifts would point at a car the driver no longer drives	Cancel the shifts automatically on the move; keep the plans	Operations must cancel or reassign the shifts first
RV-04	Planned cover counts only drivers who are approved and in the city now	A suspended driver's plans, and plans left by a moved driver, looked like cover	Count every plan and flag inactive drivers	A suspended driver who will be back tomorrow drops out of the forecast
RV-05	A hire-purchase car cannot be given to a driver who has upcoming shifts on a shared car	One car per driver on E-tiGo; the opposite direction was already blocked	Cancel the shifts automatically	Operations must clear the shifts first
RV-06	Estimates, bookings and booking changes are refused when the pickup lies inside another city's boundary; the passenger is pointed to that city, or told it has not opened	The app's chosen city was trusted, so a city not yet open could be booked under a live city's name and prices	Switch the ride to the right city automatically; only warn	A passenger standing just inside a neighbouring city must switch city in the app; it relies on accurate boundaries
RV-07	A passenger can dispute a late-cancellation fee. If upheld, a paid fee is refunded to the wallet and taken back from the driver who received it; a fee still owed is waived in full	Disputes were for completed trips only, so the client-decided fee could not be contested in the app	E-tiGo pays the refund instead of the driver; Finance-only adjustments; part-waivers of an owed fee	The driver loses the fee when a dispute is upheld; an owed fee can only be waived whole

Next Steps

#	Action	Owner
1	Give the target date for each new city, and confirm the driver minimum (30) and the OQ-22 choices	Client
2	Decide SR-6 (penalties for drivers who often release reservations) and OQ-36 (the Lost & Found return fee)	Client / Product
3	Confirm or change the engineering decisions in this report (pick option A, B or C where offered), including the Phase 2 review (RV-01 to RV-07). Each is a setting change	Client / Product
4	Confirm the dispute refund limits (₦5,000 / ₦50,000, Safety ₦50,000) and say who will hold the new Support Lead role	Client / Operations
5	Say which fleet cars are shared between drivers (shift mode), and confirm the maintenance intervals	Operations / Client
6	Confirm the permits needed in Abuja (FCT) and Rivers State	Legal

---

Sources (public pages; terms vary by market and change over time):

- Uber, booking for someone else: uber.com/ng/en/blog/request-a-ride-for-a-loved-one-today, uber.com/blog/request-a-ride-for-friends-and-loved-ones
- Bolt, rides booked for others (2–6%): citinewsroom.com
- DoorDash, voluntary scheduling for independent couriers: help.doordash.com — New Dasher Guide, dasher.doordash.com — scheduling guide
- Lagos roadworthiness checks on ride-hailing drivers: nairametrics.com
- Scheduled rides (Uber Reserve, Bolt, Lyft): see the sources in the Scheduled Rides Decisions Report
- E-tiGo: Open Questions Decision Report, Scheduled Rides Decisions Report, Cancellation Fee Proposal